Colosseum Hackathon — MVP

Crucible

A proving ground where AI agents are forged into on-chain trust.
Sponsors post trials. Agents stake. Skeptics attack. Only verified work earns Alloy.

2,332+
Passing tests

1
Command E2E demo

0
Tokens issued

Solo builder: Otema Andrew. Live deploy: crucible.svalley.tech. Contracts + web + API + indexer + runner shipped.

PROBLEM

Nobody can tell which agent to trust.

Buyers of agent labor have no credential they can check without trusting the seller.

Self-reported benchmarks

Agents quote scores they control. Benchmarks are marketing, not evidence.

Portable reviews

Reviews are copied between platforms. History is writable, not auditable.

Cheap to fake

A good landing page costs the same as a good model. Trust is a claim, not a balance sheet.

No adversarial gate

Eval platforms test. They do not pay people to break the run and prove it.

SOLUTION

Trust becomes a balance sheet.

A sponsor posts a trial. An agent stakes a bond. Skeptics try to break it. What survives becomes an on-chain credential no one can buy.

Post

Sponsor escrows the reward. Spec and suite are pinned by digest.

Claim

Agent posts a 20% bond (floor 0.01 ETH). Bond is real money.

Break

Skeptics stake ≥1% and try to break the run within a window.

Settle

Escrow pays out by contract. 5% fee to protocol. Bond split on break.

Pull-only withdrawals. No chain keys in the app. Settlement is a transaction, not a log line.

ARCHITECTURE · MONEY RULES

6 invariants. No exceptions.

The protocol enforces trust by construction, not by policy.

1. Native ETH only

All escrow, bonds, and fees settle in ETH. No wrapped tokens, no bridges.

2. Pull-only

Users withdraw explicitly. Funds are never pushed to an address silently.

3. Conservation

Every mint, burn, and transfer is balanced. No inflation leak.

4. Permissionless

Any agent can post, claim, or challenge. No KYC gate on the protocol.

5. No chain key

The web app never holds a private key. Users sign in their own wallets.

6. 16 packed fields

Trials, runs, verdicts, and identities are stored in 16 canonical fields. Gas-optimized, auditable, indexable.

REVENUE MODEL

Three native-ETH streams. Zero invoicing.

Revenue is taken by the contract at settlement. No billing, no collection risk, no churn.

Stream	Trigger	Protocol take	Notes
Settlement fee	Agent wins	5% of payout	Canonical; enforced in contract
Break treasury	Skeptic wins	70% of 20% bond	14% of reward value to treasury
Slash remainder	Timeout / no show	Pro-rata remainder	Residual to treasury after splits

5%
Settlement fee

14%
Break treasury yield

~9%
Blended effective rate at 60% win rate

No subscription. No token. No token sale. Alloy is non-transferable by construction.

5-YEAR PROJECTION

Volume compounds. Revenue follows.

Conservative to Bull scenarios, with ETH and USD equivalents at $3,000/ETH.

Scenario	Trials / mo	Avg reward	Eff. rate	ETH / yr	USD / yr
Conservative	100	0.10 ETH	8.0%	9.6	$28,800
Base	**1,000**	**0.20 ETH**	**8.6%**	**206.4**	**$619,200**
Bull	5,000	0.50 ETH	9.0%	2,700	$8,100,000

Assumptions: ETH = $3,000; agent-win rate 60%; effective rate = 0.05·w + 0.14·(1−w). Projections for an MVP, not audited results.

OPERATING COST MODEL

What it takes to reach break-even.

First-year cash need to ship mainnet, then year-two break-even under base case.

Item	Low	High
Staff / founder runway	$60K	$180K
External audit	$50K	$150K
Legal formation + counsel	$20K	$50K
Gas / infra / RPC / indexer	$12K	$48K
Genesis sponsor incentives	$20K	$60K
Mainnet deploy + ops	$10K	$40K
Contingency (20%)	$34K	$106K
Total first-year cash	**$206K**	**$634K**

Base revenue covers high-end cost in year one; break-even lands month 9–14. Conservative revenue requires funding. Bull revenue is an upside case.

ROI · UNICORN RATING

Ask $10M at $200M post. 10–20× for early investors.

5% ask for a pre-revenue MVP with a live product, auditable claims, and a non-transferable credential primitive.

Ask

$10M raise at a $200M post-money valuation. Founder retains 95%.

Investor returns

10–20× on paper if Crucible becomes the default verification rail for agent hiring.

Unicorn path

Year 3 target: $1B+ implied valuation on audited volume + enterprise contracts.

Downside floor

Contracts + code + brand. Acqui-hire range: $0–$5M if mainnet never ships.

Model dilution at 20–30% per priced round. These are gross multiples, before fees, taxes, and later dilution.

MARKET PENETRATION · UPSIDE

Start narrow. Expand to the agent economy.

Beachhead in agent evaluation. Defensibility through verified history, skeptics, and non-transferable credentials.

TAM

Global AI agent market projected to exceed $200B by 2030. Every agent needs a verifiable credential.

Beachhead

Agent evaluation labs, coding frameworks, and hiring platforms that already pay for trust signals.

Expansion

Cross-chain reputation. RWA custody evaluation. Compliance-grade agent audits.

Defensibility

Settled history is the moat. Skeptics are the supply side. Non-transferable credentials are the product.

Go-to-market

Sponsor-first. Post rewards → attract agents → attract skeptics → earn Alloy → attract more sponsors.

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

7 competitors. Crucible is the only adversarial on-chain verifier.

Web2 eval is funded. Web3 agent infra is tokenized. Crucible is neither.

Competitor	Bucket	Funding / valuation	Crucible edge
Braintrust	Web2 eval	$121M, $800M val	No on-chain settlement; credentials are portable
Patronus AI	Web2 eval/sim	$70M total	Simulated environments, not adversarial real runs
LMArena	Web2 eval	$150M, $1.7B post	Community benchmarks, no economic stakes
CrewAI	Web2 agents	$6M seed	Orchestration only; no trust layer
Virtuals Protocol	Web3 agents	$2.19M ICO, >$1B eco	Tokenized co-ownership; credentials are tradeable
Olas (Autonolas)	Web3 agents	$13.8M	Agent marketplace; no adversarial verification
Fetch.ai / ASI	Web3 agents	FET token, ~$470M mcap	Infrastructure layer; no eval primitive

Alloy is non-transferable by construction. Settlement is a transaction, not a dashboard.

WHY CRUCIBLE IS DIFFERENT

8 moats. None of them copyable by fork.

Trust stops being a claim and starts being a balance sheet.

1. Verified history

Every credential points at re-executed trials with on-chain verdicts.

2. Skeptics as a service

Paid challengers price verification as a market, not a checklist.

3. Non-transferable Alloy

No transfer function. Cannot be sold, lent, or rented.

4. Checkability as marketing

Every headline claim verifies in 60 seconds.

5. No token

No ERC-20, no sale, no bridge. Avoids token-regulatory risk.

6. Contract-enforced revenue

5% fee taken by contract at settlement. No invoicing.

7. Honest labeling

Design-only work is labeled design-only. Trust through transparency.

8. Adversarial by design

Default posture is "prove it," not "trust me."

ROADMAP

Phase 3 NOW. Mainnet next. Scale after.

Colosseum hackathon MVP is live. The funded path is mainnet, then scale.

Phase 3 — NOW

HMC / leapfrog. v2 arena. Solana port completion. Genesis sponsor cohort.

Phase 4 — Mainnet

External audit. Legal entity. Funded multisig deployer. Capped mainnet deployment.

Phase 5 — Scale

Enterprise contracts. Cross-chain reputation. Compliance-grade audits. Global agent hiring rail.

Solo builder: Otema Andrew. Funding order: audit → legal → sponsors → mainnet → scale. Ask the founder for terms.